

Branch and Bound

Assignment Problem & TSP

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Branch and Bound

- Used to find optimal solutions
- Similar to backtracking (DFS)
- Branch and Bound uses BFS (Breadth First Search or Best First Search)
- Branching: generating subproblems
- State space tree: all possible solutions

Job Assignment Problem

- n jobs and n persons
- Cost of assigning person i to job j
- Find minimum cost assignment

	$J1$	$J2$	$J3$	$J4$
A	9	2	7	8
B	6	4	3	7
C	5	8	1	8
D	7	6	9	4

Brute Force Approach

- Try all assignments
- Complexity: $O(n!)$

	<i>J1</i>	<i>J2</i>	<i>J3</i>	<i>J4</i>
<i>A</i>	9	2	7	8
<i>B</i>	6	4	3	7
<i>C</i>	5	8	1	8
<i>D</i>	7	6	9	4

Bounds (Lower & Upper)

Lower Bound (LB)

- Minimum from each row
- Or, Minimum from each column
- May not form a valid assignment

$$2 + 3 + 1 + 4 = 10$$

	<i>J1</i>	<i>J2</i>	<i>J3</i>	<i>J4</i>
<i>A</i>	9	2	7	8
<i>B</i>	6	4	3	7
<i>C</i>	5	8	1	8
<i>D</i>	7	6	9	4

Upper Bound (UB)

- Any feasible complete assignment
(Updated at leaf node)
- Best cost of a solution found so far

Branch and Bound Tree

- Expand node with least cost
- Prune higher cost nodes
- Maintain live and dead nodes

	<i>J1</i>	<i>J2</i>	<i>J3</i>	<i>J4</i>
<i>A</i>	9	2	7	8
<i>B</i>	6	4	3	7
<i>C</i>	5	8	1	8
<i>D</i>	7	6	9	4

Branch and Bound Tree

	$J1$	$J2$	$J3$	$J4$
A	9	2	7	8
B	6	4	3	7
C	5	8	1	8
D	7	6	9	4

Optimal Assignment

- $A \rightarrow J2$
- $B \rightarrow J1$
- $C \rightarrow J3$
- $D \rightarrow J4$

Total Cost = 13

	<i>J1</i>	<i>J2</i>	<i>J3</i>	<i>J4</i>
<i>A</i>	9	2	7	8
<i>B</i>	6	4	3	7
<i>C</i>	5	8	1	8
<i>D</i>	7	6	9	4

Travelling Salesman Problem (TSP)

- Visit each city exactly once
- Return to starting city
- Minimize total cost

	<i>A</i>	<i>B</i>	<i>C</i>	<i>D</i>
<i>A</i>	∞	10	5	3
<i>B</i>	8	∞	9	7
<i>C</i>	1	6	∞	9
<i>D</i>	2	3	8	∞

Brute Force

	A	B	C	D
A	∞	10	5	3
B	8	∞	9	7
C	1	6	∞	9
D	2	3	8	∞

Row & Column Reduction

Why?

- Compute Lower Bound (LB)
- Capture unavoidable cost
- Helps in pruning

	<i>A</i>	<i>B</i>	<i>C</i>	<i>D</i>
<i>A</i>	∞	10	5	3
<i>B</i>	8	∞	9	7
<i>C</i>	1	6	∞	9
<i>D</i>	2	3	8	∞

Steps

- Row reduction
- Column reduction
- $\Rightarrow$ at least one zero per row/column

$$\text{LB}(\text{child}) = \text{LB}(\text{parent})$$

+ Cost of chosen edge (from reduced matrix)

+ New reduction cost

Row Reduction

Original Matrix

	A	B	C	D
A	∞	10	5	3
B	8	∞	9	7
C	1	6	∞	9
D	2	3	8	∞

Row Reduced Matrix

	A	B	C	D
A	∞	7	2	0
B	1	∞	2	0
C	0	5	∞	8
D	0	1	6	∞

Row minima:

$$3 + 7 + 1 + 2 = 13$$

Column Reduction

Row Reduced Matrix

	A	B	C	D
A	∞	7	2	0
B	1	∞	2	0
C	0	5	∞	8
D	0	1	6	∞

Final Reduced Matrix

	A	B	C	D
A	∞	6	0	0
B	1	∞	0	0
C	0	4	∞	8
D	0	0	4	∞

Column minima:

$$1 + 2 = 3$$

Reduced Matrix (Root Node)

- Each row and column has a zero
- Lower Bound = $13 + 3 = 16$
- Start branching from here

	<i>A</i>	<i>B</i>	<i>C</i>	<i>D</i>
<i>A</i>	∞	6	0	0
<i>B</i>	1	∞	0	0
<i>C</i>	0	4	∞	8
<i>D</i>	0	0	4	∞

Branching

- Choose a zero (edge)
- Example:
 - $A \rightarrow B$
 - $A \rightarrow C$
 - $A \rightarrow D$
- Create child nodes

	A	B	C	D
A	∞	6	0	3
B	1	∞	0	0
C	0	4	∞	8
D	0	0	4	∞

Branch: $A \rightarrow B$

- Set row $A = \infty$
- Set column $B = \infty$
- Set reverse edge ($B \rightarrow A$) = ∞
- Perform reduction again

Edge Cost = 6

Reduction Cost = 0

$$LB = 16 + 6 + 0 = 22$$

Modified Matrix

	A	B	C	D
A	∞	∞	∞	∞
B	∞	∞	0	0
C	0	∞	∞	8
D	0	∞	4	∞

Branch: $A \rightarrow C$

- Set row $A = \infty$
- Set column $C = \infty$
- Set reverse edge ($C \rightarrow A$) = ∞
- Perform reduction again

Edge Cost = 0

Reduction Cost = 4

$$LB = 16 + 0 + 4 = 20$$

Modified

	A	B	C	D
A	∞	∞	∞	∞
B	1	∞	∞	0
C	∞	4	∞	8
D	0	0	∞	∞

Row C: subtract 4

Final

	A	B	C	D
A	∞	∞	∞	∞
B	1	∞	∞	0
C	∞	0	∞	4
D	0	0	∞	∞

Branch: $A \rightarrow D$

- Set row $A = \infty$
- Set column $D = \infty$
- Set reverse edge $(D \rightarrow A) = \infty$
- Perform reduction again

Edge Cost = 0

Reduction Cost = 0

$$LB = 16 + 0 + 0 = 16$$

Modified Matrix

	A	B	C	D
A	∞	∞	∞	∞
B	1	∞	0	∞
C	0	4	∞	∞
D	∞	0	4	∞

Branch: $D \rightarrow B$

- Set row $D = \infty$
- Set column $B = \infty$
- Set reverse edge ($B \rightarrow D$) = ∞
- Perform reduction again

Edge Cost = 0

Reduction Cost = 0

$$LB = 16 + 0 + 0 = 16$$

Modified

	<i>A</i>	<i>B</i>	<i>C</i>	<i>D</i>
<i>A</i>	∞	∞	∞	∞
<i>B</i>	1	∞	0	∞
<i>C</i>	0	∞	∞	∞
<i>D</i>	∞	∞	∞	∞

Reduction (No row/column reduction needed)

Branch: $D \rightarrow C$

- Set row $D = \infty$
- Set column $C = \infty$
- Set reverse edge $(C \rightarrow D) = \infty$
- Perform reduction again

Edge Cost = 4

Reduction Cost = 5

$$LB = 16 + 4 + 5 = 25$$

Modified

	<i>A</i>	<i>B</i>	<i>C</i>	<i>D</i>
<i>A</i>	∞	∞	∞	∞
<i>B</i>	1	∞	∞	∞
<i>C</i>	0	4	∞	∞
<i>D</i>	∞	∞	∞	∞

Row B: subtract 1

Column B: subtract 4

Final

	<i>A</i>	<i>B</i>	<i>C</i>	<i>D</i>
<i>A</i>	∞	∞	∞	∞
<i>B</i>	0	∞	∞	∞
<i>C</i>	0	0	∞	∞
<i>D</i>	∞	∞	∞	∞

Branch: $B \rightarrow C$

- Set row $B = \infty$
- Set column $C = \infty$
- Set reverse edge ($C \rightarrow B$) = ∞
- Perform reduction again

Edge Cost = 0

Reduction Cost = 0

$$LB = 16 + 0 + 0 = 16$$

Modified

	<i>A</i>	<i>B</i>	<i>C</i>	<i>D</i>
<i>A</i>	∞	∞	∞	∞
<i>B</i>	∞	∞	∞	∞
<i>C</i>	0	∞	∞	∞
<i>D</i>	∞	∞	∞	∞

Reduction (No reduction needed)

Final Branch & Bound Tree

TSP: Complexity & Conclusion

- Brute Force Complexity: $O(n!)$
- Branch & Bound reduces search space
- Uses Lower Bound (LB) to prune nodes
- Worst case still exponential

Observations

- Reduction gives minimum unavoidable cost
- Better bounds $\Rightarrow$ more pruning
- Performance depends on problem structure

Branch and Bound: Key Takeaways

- General technique for optimization problems
- Explores state space using bounds
- Prunes suboptimal solutions early

Key Idea

Prune if $LB \geq \text{Best Known Solution (UB)}$

Applications

- Travelling Salesman Problem (TSP)
- Job Assignment Problem
- Knapsack (0/1)